

FIELD NOTES

I've delivered 100+ Microsoft 365 migrations across LATAM.

Here are the **5 lessons** nobody tells you upfront.



→ Swipe

WHY THIS MATTERS

The migration is the easy part.

What kills projects is everything that happens in the **90 days before** and the **90 days after**.

After 100+ projects — IMAP, Google Workspace, file servers, tenant-to-tenant — the same 5 mistakes show up every time.



Save this. Share with your team.

01

Discovery is not a checklist. It's a negotiation.

Half of "scope creep" is just discovery you skipped. Shared mailboxes nobody owns. Distribution lists tied to legacy apps. Public folders with 12 years of litigation evidence.

→ **Spend 2x more time in discovery. You'll spend 5x less in remediation.**

02

Identity comes first. Always. No exceptions.

If Entra ID isn't clean before you migrate mailboxes, you're moving broken accounts to a more expensive platform. Audit MFA coverage, conditional access baselines, hybrid sync health, and orphaned objects BEFORE the first mailbox moves.

→ **No clean identity, no migration.**

03

Pilot users are not random. They are political.

The wrong 50 pilot users will kill the rollout in week 2. Pick: 1 executive sponsor, 2 vocal skeptics, 5 power users from different departments, and 1 person from legal/compliance.

→ **If the skeptics convert, the rest follow.**

04

Communication beats tooling.

BitTitan, Quest On-Demand, native cutover — all of them work. What doesn't work: a 3-line email on Friday saying "your mailbox will move this weekend". Build a comms cadence: T-30, T-14, T-7, T-1, day-of, T+1, T+7. Same template. Same channel. Every wave.

→ **Predictability is the feature users buy.**

05

The project ends 90 days after go-live, not on go-live.

Day 0 = mailbox moved. Day 90 = users actually changed behavior. Plan for: license rebalancing, DLP tuning, Conditional Access exceptions cleanup, OneDrive known folder move, adoption metrics review.

→ **No post-migration plan = no ROI.**

THE PATTERN

The pattern behind all 5



TEAMS THAT FAIL

Treat migration as a **TECHNICAL** project.



TEAMS THAT SUCCEED

Treat it as a **CHANGE** project that happens to use technology.

The tools have been solved. **The humans haven't.**

THE CHECKLIST

Before your next M365 migration, verify all 7:

- ☐ Discovery doc signed by business owner
- ☐ Entra ID baseline audit completed
- ☐ Pilot user list with named individuals
- ☐ Comms cadence template approved
- ☐ Rollback plan documented and tested
- ☐ Day +30 / +60 / +90 review scheduled
- ☐ Success metrics defined in writing

Miss one → expect rework.

LET'S CONNECT

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I write weekly about **Microsoft 365 Copilot adoption, secure migrations, and Modern Work.**



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